

PREKSHA KOTHARI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Strategic Product Professional with 8+ years of experience in defining product roadmaps and requirements, conducting market analysis, and managing product lifecycle. Proven skills in Agile methodologies and UI/UX design for product lifecycle management securing \$17K in research funding and enhancing client satisfaction while working on 6 products. Renowned for creating innovative products, leading cross-functional teams, building strong stakeholder relationships, and consistently driving high-impact business results.
- Information systems Professional with experience in anticipating and understanding customer expectations, and ensure customer requirements are met and expectations appropriately managed. Able to build partner relationships with customers, and focus on solving their problems.
- Experience in Project planning, estimating, tracking, management, providing guidance, and direction for Technology and Infrastructure risks and controls.
- Proficient in COTS, custom application hosting, deployment, upgrades, patching and maintenance.
- Possess extensive experience in managing projects through the full project lifecycle, encompassing specification, development, testing and implementation.
- Worked in the latest software implementation environments, J2EE environments with good knowledge in the designing of Portals, System Migration, Oracle databases, Data warehouse and BI.
- Full systems development lifecycle experience with a good knowledge of six sigma, SOA, Cloud, Data Centers, different technologies and tools (RTC, RQM, Rally, Jira and Clarity).
- Excelled in overseeing multiple projects directed toward strategic business and organizational objectives.
- Highly motivated, organized and results oriented with excellent interpersonal, communication and presentation skills with capability of adapting to new and fast changing technologies.
- Responsible and accountable for the management of multiple projects directed toward strategic business and other organizational objectives.
- Built credibility, established rapport, and maintained communication with stakeholders at multiple levels, including those external to the organization.
- Managed cost, schedule, and performance of projects, while working to ensure their ultimate success.
- Maintained continuous alignment of program scope with strategic business objectives, and made recommendations to modify the program to enhance effectiveness toward the business result or strategic intent.
- Coached, mentored and led personnel within a technical team environment.

SKILLS

Competencies: A/B Testing, Product Lifecycle, Product Development, Hypothesis Testing & Validation, User Interviews, Roadmaps, UI/UX Principles, Voice of Customer (VoC), User Journey & Personas, Data Visualization, Agile & Scrum Methodology, Decision and Risk Analysis, Conflict Management

Languages & Syntax: C, C++, Python, R, Java, JavaScript, JSON, HTML/CSS, SQL, Rest APIs, NoSQL(MongoDB), Tensorflow

Tools: PostgreSQL, Postman, Microsoft Office Suite, Selenium, Figma, Miro, ProductBoard, Adobe Suite, MS Power BI, Alteryx, Salesforce, MS Azure, AWS, Tableau, Minitab, Slack, JIRA, Confluence, MS Visio, Lucid Charts, Aha, Git, Microsoft Dynamics 365, Hadoop Database, PrecisionTree

Certifications: Certified Product Manager, Certified ScrumMaster

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology, Computer Science & Engineering
SRM University-2015

Chennai, TN

Graduated with honors in the top 3% of the class.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Project Manager/Product Owner
Wuxi Advanced Therapies, Malvern, PA

April 2022 - Till Date

Description: The Advanced Therapies business unit of WuXi AppTec is a global Contract Testing, Development and Manufacturing Organization (CTDMO) dedicated to accelerating and transforming discovery, development, manufacturing, and commercialization of cell and gene therapies.

Key Responsibilities:

- Managed relationships between the internal project team, Client, and additional key stakeholders to ensure that sufficient coordination efforts were in place.
- Defined LOE for User stories in Team Foundation Server (TFS),
- Conducted Project Kick off meeting, daily standups, Sprint planning meetings, Sprint Review, Sprint Retrospective and Performance review meeting.
- Tracked the Project Cost, Timeline and Scope. Ensured Client processes and templates being used consistently throughout the project.
- Documented and developed detailed communication plan to ensure timely and effective communications took place throughout the project lifecycle.
- Logged detailed project risk to ensure that risks were identified and mitigated per the documented plan. Tracked issues in issue log and included them in weekly status report.

Project Manager/Product Owner
RH Downing, Cary, NC

Dec 2020 - March 2022

Description: At R.H. Downing, we provide our manufacturers with world class service combined with years of expertise. We are proud to represent our clients in automotive, retail, industrial, performance, MRO, and hardware industries.

Key Responsibilities:

- Served as the liaison between business users, technology teams and operations.
- Established production issues and incidents meeting with business subject matter experts and the technical team.
- Created and implemented strategic and tactical plans. Coordinated and monitored budgets, resources, and infrastructure. Performed Cost Benefit Analysis and Created RFI and SWOT analysis document for vendor selection.
- Worked closely with the client. Ensured adequate levels of documentation are produced as part of the technical solution.
- Developed and maintain a Communications Plan and kept the business and IT communities apprised of project plans and related implications. Tracked the Project Cost, Timeline, Scope and Managed the Team.

- Responsible and accountable for the management of multiple projects directed toward strategic business and other organizational objectives.
- Built credibility, established rapport, and maintained communication with stakeholders at multiple levels, including those external to the organization.
- Managed cost, schedule, and performance of projects, while working to ensure their ultimate success.
- Maintained continuous alignment of program scope with strategic business objectives, and made recommendations to modify the program to enhance effectiveness toward the business result or strategic intent.
- Coached, mentored and led personnel within a technical team environment.
- Presented periodic Dashboard reports on current projects, future opportunities and client issues. Ensured the hand - over to operational support (Infrastructure Support, Applications Support and Service Management).
- Performed risk analysis, Impact analysis on other systems and forecasted capacity using Clarity Tool. Made sure new implementation hasn't impacted other systems/ related projects.
- Ensured projects are planned and executed in-line with the PMO approach: Created Status reports, tracked the Project and resolved the Project issues.

Product Owner

Aug 2019 - Nov 2020

American Technology Consulting USA

Description: I led the entire product development lifecycle using agile processes of a 360 Agent Facing Tool for financial institutions, which provides a seamless and user-friendly interface for secure and effortless debit card management to meet diverse user needs, ensuring reliability and convenience at every step for a stress-free banking experience.

Key Responsibilities:

- Collaborated with key stakeholders to understand and document their product visions, needs, and requirements.
- Created product plans, strategy & roadmaps on Aha and synchronized cross-functional teams.
- Responsible for prioritizing the product backlog and creating and accepting epics & user stories.
- Performed market analysis & gap analysis on the previous reporting information and the new information.
- Crafted wireframes and mockups, providing senior executives with a vision for improved user experience.
- Conducted individual and group (JAD) sessions with business and technical units including directorial leaders.
- Evaluated and tracked market problems and customer requirements to drive product roadmap definition.
- Facilitating release planning, sprint planning, and retrospectives and was responsible for creating tasks on JIRA.
- Identified the problems & defects that could delay the demo & delivery of the user stories in the Agile delivery cycle.
- Executed test scripts during multiple release phases and conducted user acceptance testing (UAT) to check the feature.
- Performed data analysis and data mapping of existing data to track the metrics and KPIs of the product post-launch.
- Managed the product lifecycle, from ideation to deployment to launch by working diligently with Release Managers, Program managers, scrum teams, technology teams, and UX/UI teams.
- Followed SDLC in a process for planning, creating, testing, and deploying IT resources and servers.

Description: Led and managed the entire AI product built with Python and machine learning. This tool expertly identifies objects, easing common pain points in object detection. It's like boosting your computer vision, helping people see and understand things faster and better.

Key Responsibilities:

- Led cross-functional teams, including engineers, designers, and marketers, through the entire product lifecycle, from ideation to launch.
- Collaborated with stakeholders by understanding their needs & transforming them into functional products.
- Defined product vision & objectives, validated product features, and wrote the documentation on it.
- Conducted root cause analysis for defining the product roadmap & strategy and prioritizing the product features.
- Conducted market research of an end-to-end product for measuring the OKR and accelerating product growth.
- Conducted weekly brainstorming sessions to contribute ideas for product development strategies.
- Designed MVP prototypes/wireframes of products using insights gathered from customer interviews & user personas.
- Created and delivered presentations and reports to stakeholders on every stage of prototype design.
- Conducted pre-launch/beta testing to verify product functionality and usability before shipping.
- Developed and structured product backlogs using a combination of epics and user stories.
- Analyzed market trends and competitor products for better positioning of our product in the market.
- Worked closely with legal experts and the data science team, ensuring strict adherence to product compliance & data privacy regulations throughout all stages of product development.
- Led trade-off analyses to prioritize features and functionalities, balancing user feedback.
- Served as a Subject Matter Expert (SME) in the development of technical documents related to the implementation of data received.
- Interpreted large datasets using Microsoft Power BI, presenting complex data in a clear, actionable format.

Achievements:

- Secured \$17K in research funding upon the addition of more features to the machine-learning-based product.
- Reduced 46 errors in the ML algorithm using Python to improve product performance.
- Boosted the product accuracy with 80% clarity for object detection up to 4300 images.
- Presented product pitch to two industry partners successfully, leading to a positive decision in approval of budget cost involved in opting for new technologies, designs, and methodologies.

Description: I led the creation of several products: 'mySharePlan' for easy equity and wealth management, 'noq-noq' to manage visitors efficiently, 'Hydrameet' for smooth video calls, and an intuitive e-voting app. Each product emphasizes user-friendly design and technological innovation.

Key Responsibilities:

- Led the software team of 5 engineers and developed the front end and back end of an e-voting application.
- Designed the UI/UX of a SaaS product using Figma, keeping user feedback and requirements in mind.
- Developed 3 software using HTML/CSS, Angular JS, SQL, Rest APIs, and Node JS.
- Conducted A/B testing to optimize the user experience and enhance product performance.
- Implemented automation testing strategies by integrating selenium into the software development lifecycle (SDLC).
- Deployed software on Microsoft Azure for smooth operations & optimal use of cloud resources.
- Interfaced with 3 product owners on an active basis for managing the product backlog and sprint activities.
- Defined and documented product requirements and objectives.
- Worked closely with the testing team for troubleshooting, debug errors, and upgrading the existing software.
- Created use case diagrams using Microsoft Visio and conducted user story & UML review sessions.
- Oversaw user acceptance testing (UAT) to validate product functionality and user-friendliness.

Achievements:

- Secured \$1M in funding for successfully launching the Hydrameet product.
- Increased the development pace by 4.5 hours through documentation of product requirements.
- Reduced 38 bugs per day through the implementation of automation testing.
- Reduced code errors from 400 to 100 per month.
- Increased client satisfaction scores by 30 points.
- Enhanced user interface led to 50 additional daily active users.
- Improved 25% team productivity by converting complex business requirements into understandable user stories.

Product Manager
Oswal Polyplast Pvt Ltd

March 2015 - Jun 2016
Chennai, TN

Description: I managed the creation of an "Interactive Product Catalog," a digital tool using Augmented Reality (AR) that enables businesses to showcase their products more engagingly than traditional static catalogs. It employs 3D visualizations, interactive features, and real-time data integration to offer the end-users a comprehensive view of products.

Key Responsibilities:

- Managed the product roadmap, prioritizing features and improvements based on user feedback.
- Leveraged data to define & target key customer segments and engagement strategies based on KPI metrics.
- Prioritized and managed a product backlog, weighing trade-offs, communicating outcomes to stakeholders.
- Wrote and presented 4 reports/month on product performance and made recommendations for improvement.
- Worked with product management and engineering teams to develop data-driven solutions to product problems.

- Defined & executed go-to-market (GTM) strategies for the product within the first three months post-launch.
- Created and delivered 6 product presentations to internal and external stakeholders.
- Engaged in user testing sessions, gathering direct feedback to refine product functionalities.
- Defined and analyzed metrics that inform the success of the product and also help in decision-making.
- Worked with customers to clearly understand the customer use cases and pain points.

Achievements:

- Reduced customer query resolution time by 3 hours.
- Successfully introduced 3 new languages to the catalog.
- Reduced the time taken for product listing updates by 2 days.